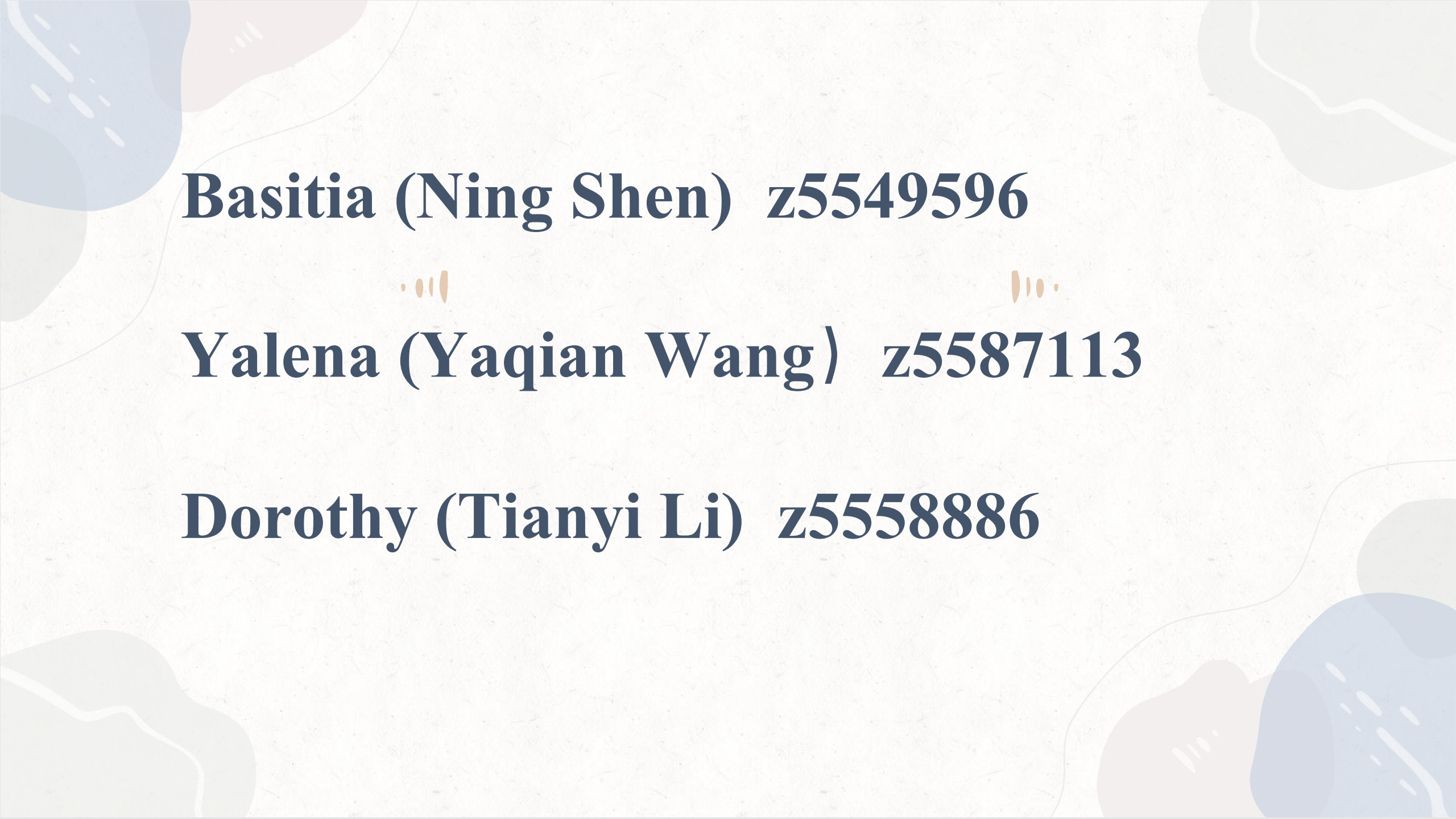




From Cool Culture to Brand Building: How Public Relations Becomes a Cultural Mediator?



Basitia (Ning Shen) z5549596

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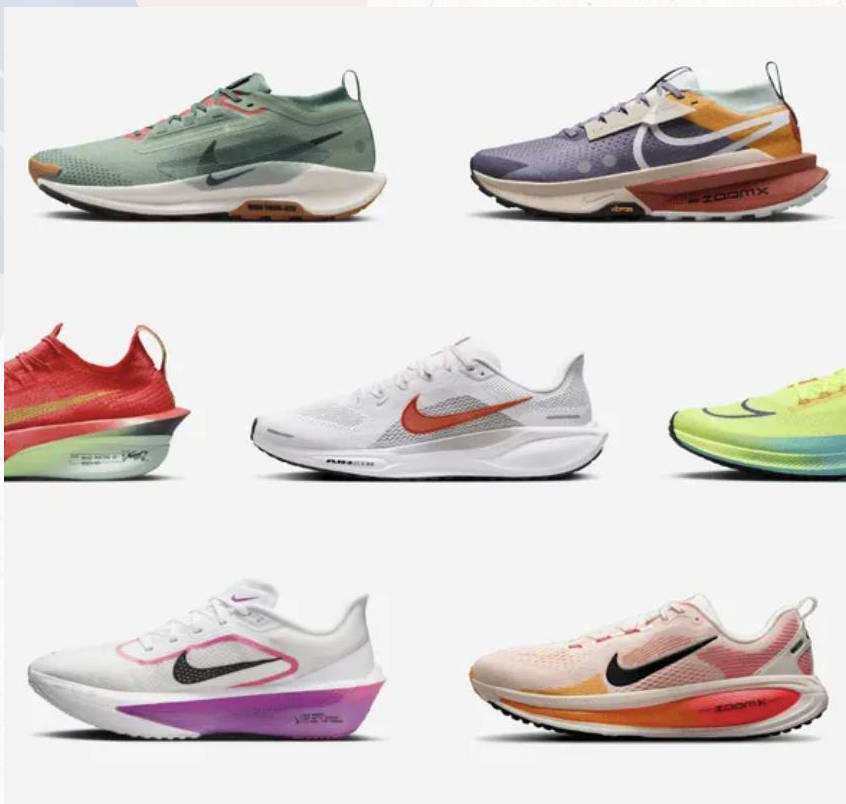
Yalena (Yaqian Wang) z5587113

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01

Cool Culture



Which brands do you think are **cool**?

Do you think they are naturally cool, or is it the brand PR that makes them look cool?



“Cool” is social capital, defined by a few individuals, discovered, promoted, and managed by PR.

——“The Coolhunt” Gladwell (1997)

What are the Features of Cool Culture?

- 1 It defined by a few individuals
- 2 Coolhunting Paradox : The paradox of uniqueness vs. mainstream
- 3 Brands use cool culture to attract consumers

1 It defined by a few individuals

Cool culture was initially liked by a small group of people. They attracted others with similar interests, formed their own cultural circle, and defined what this cool culture represents.

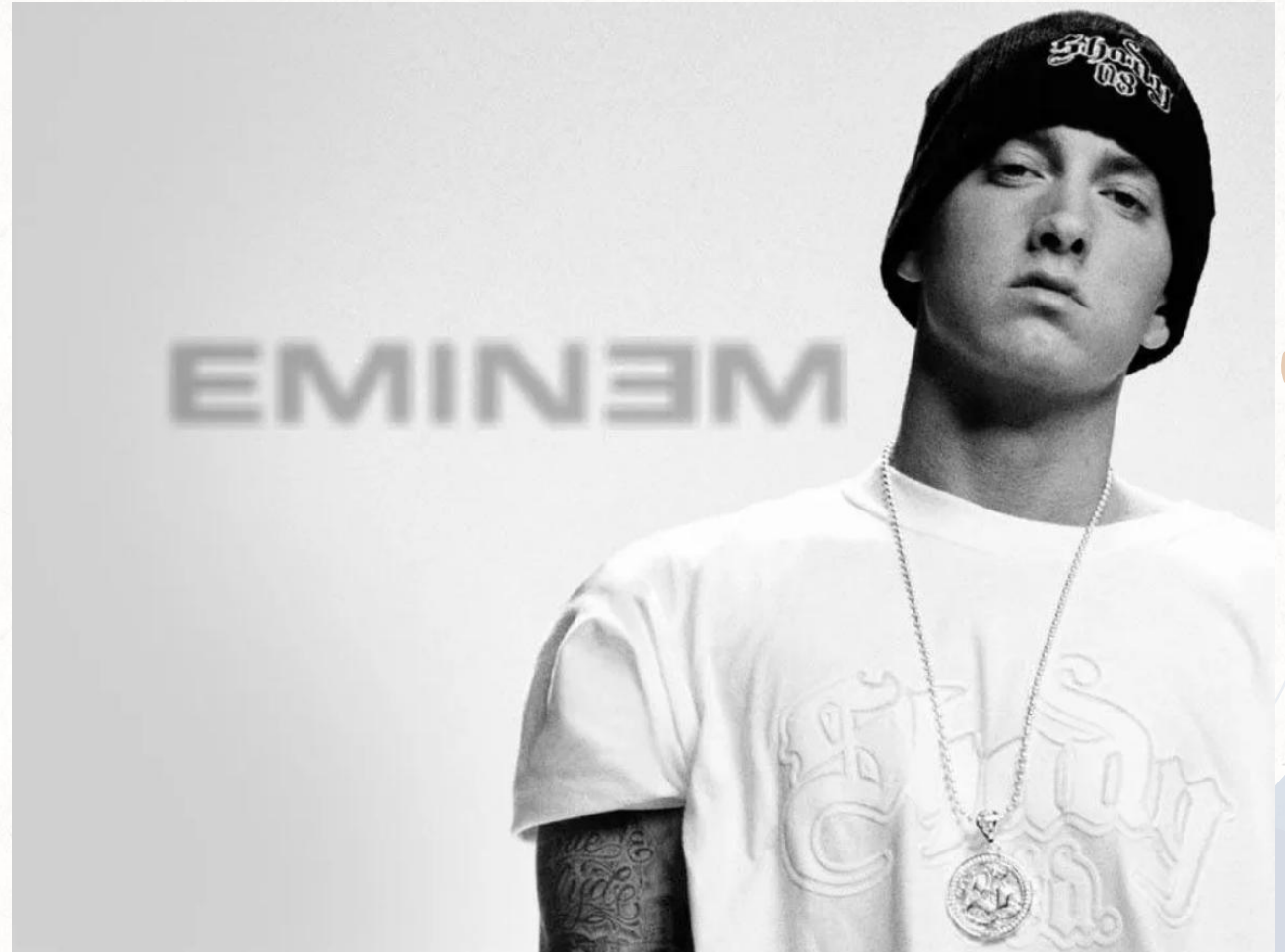
1 It defined by a few individuals

When something stops being unique, it ceases to be cool. Once an item or trend becomes widespread and mainstream, its uniqueness and rarity disappear, and with that, its 'coolness' gradually fades away. The most typical example is **subculture.**

1 It defined by a few individuals

Subcultures:

**1. Music-Related
Subcultures: Hip-Hop**
– A street culture encompassing rap music, breakdancing, graffiti, and DJing.



1

It defined by a few individuals

Subcultures:

2. VTuber Culture – Involves virtual avatars performing live streams, singing, and interacting with fans, popular in communities like Hololive and NIJISANJI.



1 It defined by a few individuals

Subcultures:

3. Cyberpunk – A futuristic subculture blending high-tech innovation with dystopian themes, inspired by works like Blade Runner and Cyberpunk 2077.



2

Coolhunting Paradox

Coolhunting:

The article mentions Baysie Wightman (Converse) and DeeDee Gordon (L Report) as cool hunters who specialize in scouting the cutting-edge trends in the streets.

2

Coolhunting Paradox

Discovering what's cool makes it disappear.

When coolness is accepted by mainstream brands and the general public, it is no longer cool.

In other words, coolness has a lifecycle—either it remains niche, or once it becomes mainstream, it enters a decline phase.

3 Brands use cool culture to attract consumers

In the world of marketing, being “cool” is one of the most powerful tools for attracting consumers.

3 Brands use cool culture to attract consumers

There is a saying in China: "Pursuing niche trends is, in itself, a mainstream phenomenon." This not only explains Theory 2——Coolhunting Paradox, but also provides inspiration——businesses can leverage people's desire to chase niche trends to guide and stimulate consumption, ultimately turning it into profit.

Why isn't Supreme as cool as it used to be ?

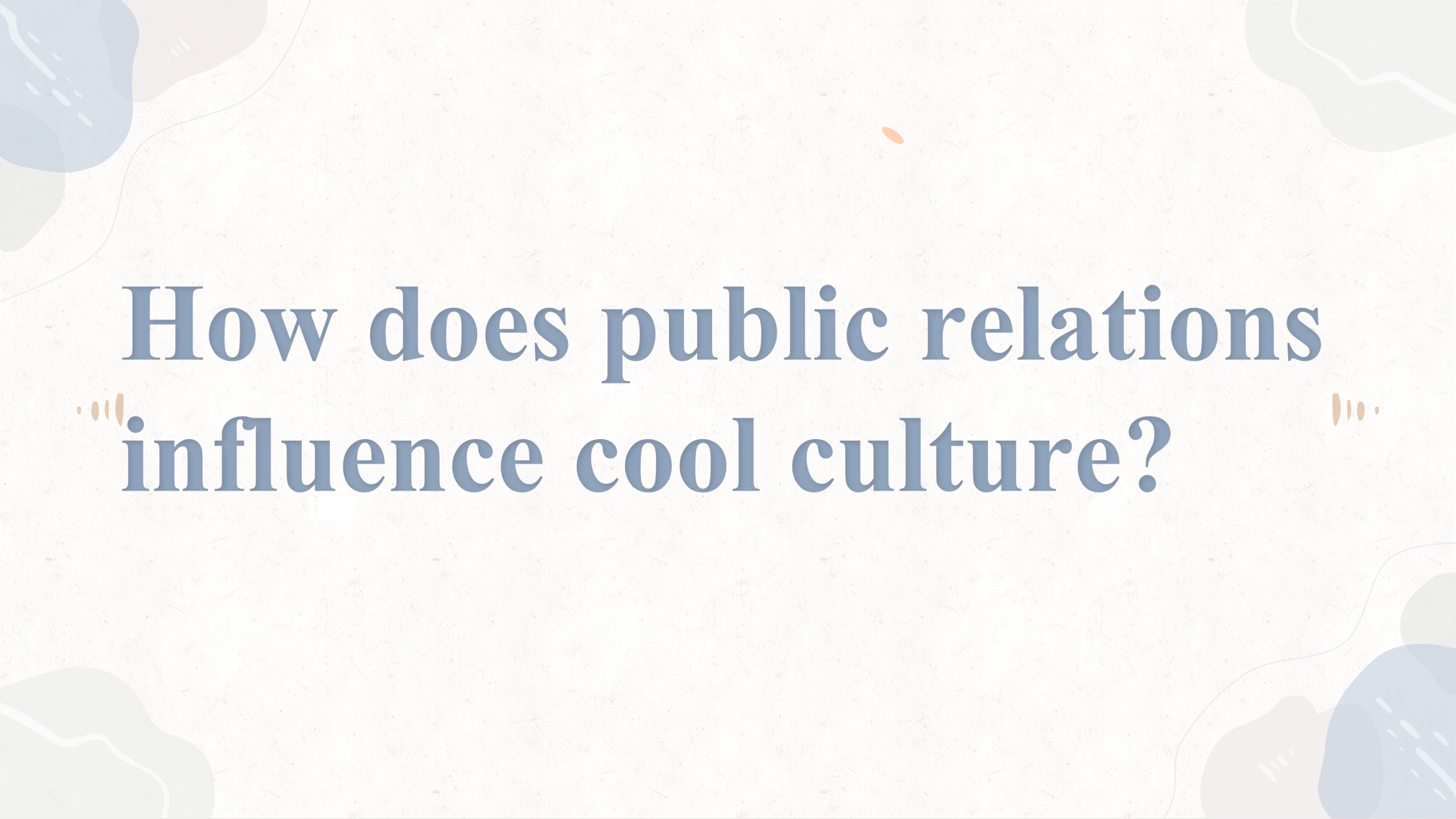


Initially, Supreme was just a brand within New York's street skateboarding culture, catering to skaters and subcultural communities.

However, as Supreme gained more attention, celebrities, influencers, and mainstream consumers all jumped on board. Today, Supreme's iconic Box Logo is widely replicated, and resale prices have skyrocketed.

Yet, many of its original core fans believe it is "no longer cool" because it has lost its exclusivity and become part of mainstream culture.

• In short, it has gone mainstream, and the consumers who liked Supreme because it was niche no longer follow it once they feel it is no longer exclusive.



How does public relations
influence cool culture?

PR as a Cultural Intermediary

Lee Edwards (2012)

Cultural Mediation

PR connects brands, consumers, and cultural trends, shaping social perception.

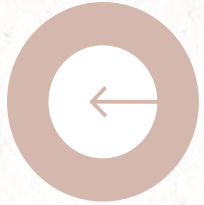
Symbolic Power

PR as a tool of "symbolic power". Whoever controls the discourse defines what is "cool" (Discursive Struggle).



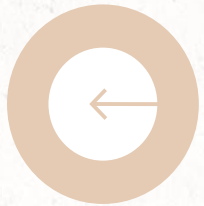
Identifying Trends

Spotting emerging cultural movements and consumer interests.



Amplifying Trend

Leveraging media and influencers to make trends mainstream.



Commercializing Trends

Transforming cultural trends into marketable products or services.



Maintaining Cultural Identity

Ensuring brand authenticity while adapting to trends.

02

Cases Study

SKIMS & Tesla



SKIMS

How SKIMS turned niche shapewear into a global trend ?



Corset - Born in 16th centuries



Other corsets/ shapewears



SKIMS shapewear

COOL was discovered, not created. (Gladwell, 1997)

SKIMS

How SKIMS used PR to turn into a symbol of female empowerment ?



Celebrity Effect/ PR

Kim Kardashian

Celebrating: Rose & SKIMS



Viral spread on social media

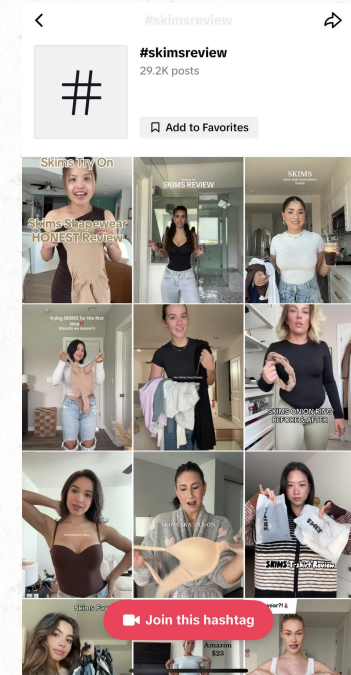
Viral Marketing



Hungry Marketing

Often sold out — Creating a “sense of scarcity”

Hunger marketing effectively stimulates consumer emotions, leading to impulse purchases. (Wu et al. 2019)





Tesla

How Tesla turned into a tech trend through PR?



Tesla's Mission
To accolorate the world's transition to sustainable energy.

The car is no longer a means of transportation, it is a fashion item, a piece of technological development and following environmentalism

Tesla

Tesla's PR Strategies



Celebrity Effect/ PR & Controversy

Elon Musk --> create a buzz

(At the 2019 Cybertruck launch, Musk demonstrated bulletproof glass that ended up being smashed and cracked.)

The best approach is moderate controversy that sparks discussion without alienating customers. (Owoeye, 2019)



Rely on social media to drive heat without traditional advertising

Success in viral marketing depends on building trust, fostering community participation, and leveraging co-creation with consumers. (Miller & Lammas, 2010)



Hungry Marketing

Cybertruck is available for pre-order only, creating a high-end feel

SKIMS vs Tesla

SKIMS

Tesla

Brand Tone

Body Inclusion

Futuristic Trends

Mode of transmission

Social Media & Celebrity Marketing

Social Media & Create a buzz

The Audiences

Female consumer group

High-tech consumer group

Trend Forecasting + PR = Branding Success!



A launch conference for a self-created brand

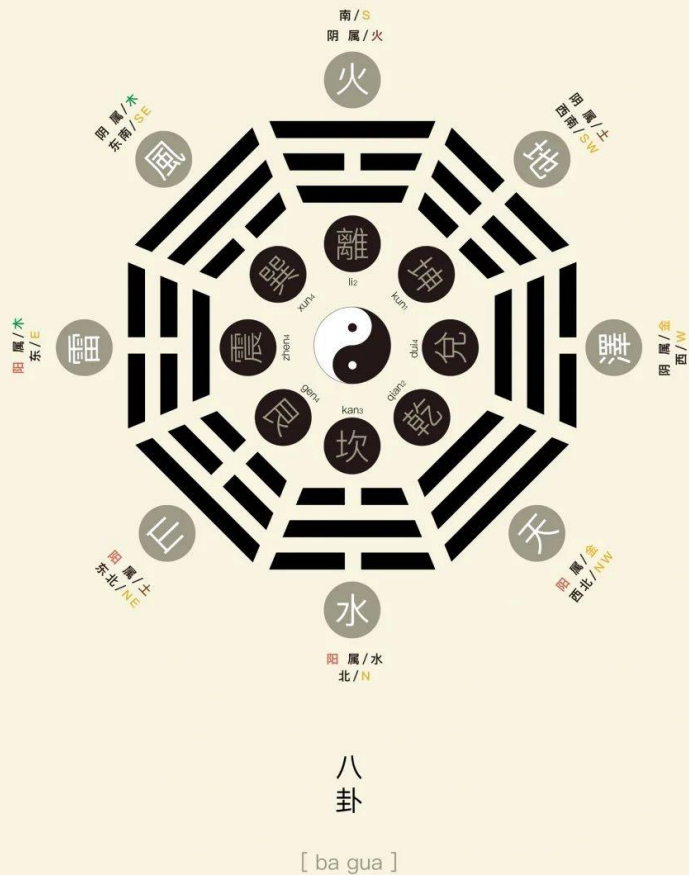
AURACLE

Aura + Oracle

Wear the Future, Unlock Your Destiny



Do you believe your destiny can be influenced by energy alignment?



The Bagua • Eight Trigrams • King Wen(Later Heaven)

Core Logic

People don't buy crystals;
they buy the feeling of controlling their destiny

Content

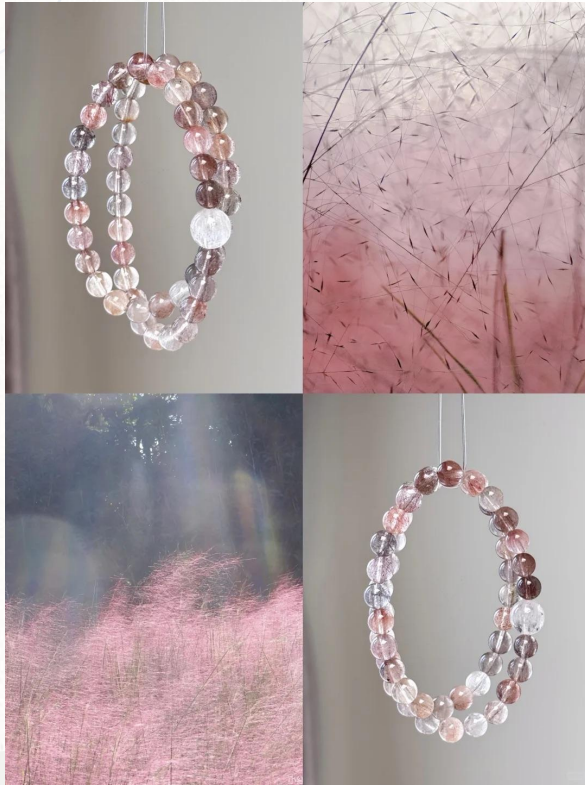
Aura + Oracle = AURACLE

Feng Shui = (Eastern Energy Philosophy) ✓

Do you know your Five Elements? Choosing the right crystal can harmonize your energy

Product Matrix Design

Love & Harmony Series



Enhance your love luck and improve your interpersonal relationships

Wealth Expansion Series



Improve your luck with side income and help your career succeed

Emperor Protection Series



Prevent disasters and avoid evil, guard against villains



Luxury Pricing Model

(Exclusivity) + (Ritual) + (Social Status) ✓

Feng shui+Jewellery = (Spiritual Luxury)

Price: 1000 aud - 500000 aud=Limited Edition Numbering, Jewelry Blessing Ceremony

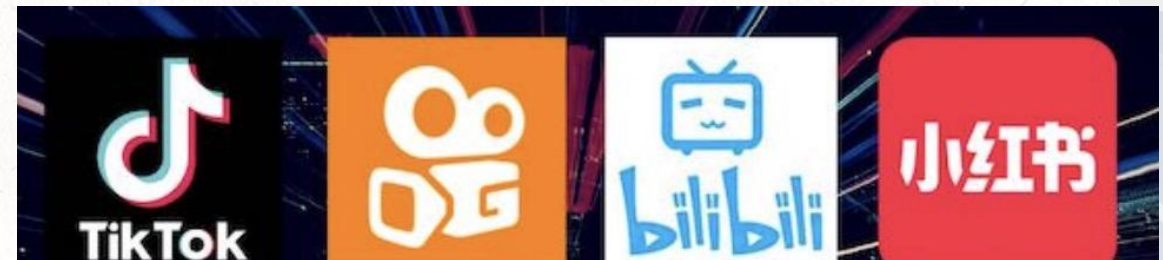
PR & Marketing Strategy

How to Make AURACLE Both Luxury and Feng Shui Spiritual? 111

Master Endorsement: Endorsed by Feng Shui Masters

KOL & Influencer Marketing: Social Media Trend Exposure

Exclusive Energy Consultation





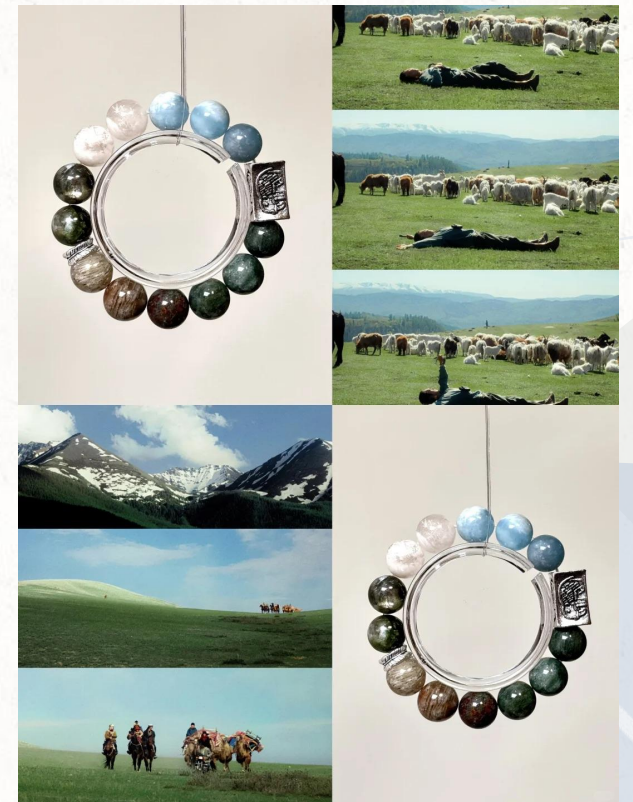
If you are willing to invest, please raise your hand



Unveiling AURACLE's Marketing Tactics

Marketing Psychology Techniques: Sunk Cost Fallacy

“If you spent ¥10,000 on a crystal, would you be willing to admit it’s useless?”



Social Proof

“If all celebrities, influencers, and social media users are sharing their AUI luck stories, would you still doubt its power?”



Cognitive Dissonance

“You’ve been told that Feng Shui jewelry works. Would you now deny something you’ve believed in?”



CONCLUSION

- 1 ☐ Cool culture = short-lived but influential, PR amplifies its value through cultural mediation.
- 2 ☐ Brands need PR to maintain “coolness”, but they cannot let “coolness” be destroyed by market mainstreaming.
- 3 ☐ Through the AURACLE brand experiment, we demonstrated how PR can create cultural identity, influence consumer behavior, and build commercial value.

Last question: Do you think “coolness” can be created? Or does PR just amplify existing trends?



THANK YOU

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